

# English Ladder

## Student Workbook

### Grammar Concepts #20

A polished self-study handout designed for print or tablet use. Read the concept, notice the pattern, and then complete the matching practice set on your own.



Grammar Concepts #20

Key Points

Bonus Section:

#### Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **Grammar Concepts #20** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

**ENGLISH LADDER**

### Concept #20 ► Money Terms

The **value** is what the consumer or average market participant will pay.  
The **price** the amount of money the seller is asking for.

|                                  |                                            |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| <b>Q:</b> How much does it cost? | <b>A:</b> It costs more than I can afford. |
| What is its worth/value?         | Its value is higher than I expected.       |
| What is its price?               | The price is \$5/high/low.                 |
| How expensive/cheap is it?       | It is too expensive for me.                |
| What are you charging for this?  | We are charging \$5 for it.                |
| It is reasonable/affordable?     | It is quite reasonable/affordable.         |

**Price:** A general usage term.  
**Charge:** Commonly, extra money paid for an activity.  
**Fare:** Money paid for transportation.  
**Fee:** A small additional payment for a service.  
**Cost:** Commonly, the sum of many purchases.  
**Bill:** Invoice for household expenses & utilities.  
**Payment:** A fraction of a costly product paid monthly.  
**Expense:** A cost from the perspective of budgeting.

Products and services  
are **expensive** or  
**inexpensive**.

Prices, charges, fares,  
fees, and costs are **high**  
or **low**.

Bills, payments, and  
expenses are **large** or  
**small**.

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## Core Idea

The image shows several question formats used to inquire about cost:

### Quick reference

|                                                  |                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Asking Questions About Price and Value        | "How much does it cost?"                                             |
| 2. Responding to Price Inquiries                 | "It costs more than I can afford."                                   |
| 3. Vocabulary Distinctions                       | Price: A general usage term                                          |
| 3. Vocabulary Distinctions                       | "The price of the shirt was \$25."                                   |
| 4. Adjectives for Describing Prices and Products | "Organic produce is often more expensive than conventional options." |
| 4. Adjectives for Describing Prices and Products | Expensive - more expensive - most expensive                          |

## Key Points

### 1. Asking Questions About Price and Value

- "How much does it cost?"
- "What is its worth/value?"
- "What is its price?"
- "How expensive/cheap is it?"
- "What are you charging for this?"
- "Is it reasonable/affordable?"

These questions use different interrogative structures:

Used with adjectives like "much," "expensive," or "cheap" Example: "How expensive is that new smartphone?"

Used to ask about specific attributes like worth, value, or price Example: "What is the value of this antique watch?"

Begin with "Is" or "Are" to ask about qualities like reasonableness or affordability Example: "Is this apartment affordable for a student?"



## 2. Responding to Price Inquiries

The image provides several example responses:

- "It costs more than I can afford."
- "Its value is higher than I expected."
- "The price is \$5/high/low."
- "It is too expensive for me."
- "We are charging \$5 for it."
- "It is quite reasonable/affordable."

These responses demonstrate various grammatical structures:

Using "more than" or "higher than" to compare prices or values Example: "The concert tickets cost more than we budgeted for."

Expressing that something exceeds a desirable or acceptable level Example: "This restaurant is too expensive for our group dinner."

Using "are charging" to indicate an ongoing price or fee Example: "They are charging \$50 per hour for tutoring services."

Modifying adjectives like "reasonable" or "affordable" Example: "The new café's prices are quite reasonable for the quality of food they serve."

## 3. Vocabulary Distinctions

The image defines several related terms:

- Price: A general usage term
- Charge: Commonly, extra money paid for an activity
- Fare: Money paid for transportation
- Fee: A small additional payment for a service
- Cost: Commonly, the sum of many purchases
- Bill: Invoice for household expenses & utilities
- Payment: A fraction of a costly product paid monthly
- Expense: A cost from the perspective of budgeting

When using these terms, pay attention to their specific contexts:

Example sentences:

- "The price of the shirt was \$25."
- "There's an additional charge of \$10 for gift wrapping."
- "The bus fare from the airport to downtown is \$15."



- "Our bank charges a monthly fee of \$5 for the checking account."
- "The total cost of the home renovation project exceeded our budget."
- "Don't forget to pay the electricity bill by the end of the month."
- "The car payments are \$300 per month for the next five years."
- "We need to reduce our monthly expenses to save more money."

#### 4. Adjectives for Describing Prices and Products

The image mentions that products and services can be "expensive" or "inexpensive," and that prices, charges, fares, fees, and costs can be "high" or "low." Bills, payments, and expenses can be "large" or "small."

Example sentences:

- "Organic produce is often more expensive than conventional options."
- "Public transportation is usually an inexpensive way to travel around the city."
- "Hotel rates are high during the peak tourist season."
- "The entrance fee to the museum is quite low for students."
- "Our electricity bills are typically larger in winter due to heating costs."

Remember that when using these adjectives, you can create comparative and superlative forms:

- Expensive - more expensive - most expensive
- High - higher - highest
- Low - lower - lowest

Example: "Among all the restaurants we visited, this one had the most expensive menu but the lowest service charges."

By understanding and practicing these terms and structures, non-native English speakers can become more comfortable discussing money-related topics in various contexts.

## Bonus Section:

### Money & Financial Terms: Advanced Information

- Price vs. Cost: Price: The amount of money required to purchase something. Example: The price of the book is \$20. Cost: The total amount of money spent on acquiring, producing, or maintaining something. Example: The cost of repairing the car was higher than expected.
- Expense vs. Expenditure: Expense: A specific amount of money spent on something. Example: Her monthly expenses include rent, utilities, and groceries. Expenditure: The action of spending funds, often referring to larger amounts or over a period. Example: Government expenditures on infrastructure are increasing.
- Income vs. Revenue: Income: Money received, especially on a regular basis, for work or through investments. Example: His annual income is \$50,000. Revenue: The total income generated by a company or organization. Example: The company's revenue increased by 10% last year.



- Profit vs. Gain: Profit: The financial benefit when the revenue from business activities exceeds the expenses, costs, and taxes. Example: The company made a profit of \$2 million. Gain: An increase in wealth or resources, which can be financial or non-financial. Example: He had a significant gain in his stock investments.

Examples in Sentences:

- The price of the new laptop is quite high.
- The cost of living in the city is rising.
- She tracks her daily expenses carefully.
- Government expenditure on healthcare is essential.
- His primary source of income is his job.
- The company's revenue exceeded expectations.
- They made a profit after selling the old house.
- There was a substantial gain in the value of their property.

Note the differences and specific contexts in which these terms are used.



## Practice Check

Answer the quiz questions below with responses consistent with the grammar concepts taught on the left.

### ITEM 01

**Which question is best for inquiring about the cost of a laptop?**

- A) How much does this laptop cost?
- B) How is the price of this laptop?
- C) Is this laptop expensive?
- D) Does this laptop cost a lot?

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

### ITEM 02

**Which sentence correctly compares the price of a phone to someone's budget?**

- A) The new phone costs more than I can afford.
- B) The new phone costs expensive than I can afford.
- C) The new phone costs as I can afford.
- D) The new phone costs how I can afford.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

### ITEM 03

**Which sentence best expresses that a car's price exceeds someone's budget?**

- A) This car is very expensive for me.
- B) This car is too expensive for me.
- C) This car is so expensive for me.
- D) This car is much expensive for me.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 04**

**Which sentence correctly describes an ongoing pricing situation for concert tickets?**

- A) They charge \$50 for the concert tickets.
- B) They are charge \$50 for the concert tickets.
- C) They charging \$50 for the concert tickets.
- D) They are charging \$50 for the concert tickets.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 05**

**Which sentence best describes the prices at a new café?**

- A) The new café's price is very reasonable.
- B) The new café's prices are quite reasonable.
- C) The new café's prices are much reasonable.
- D) The new café's prices are much reasonable.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 06**

**Which sentence correctly describes an additional cost for Wi-Fi at a hotel?**

- A) The hotel has an extra price for Wi-Fi.
- B) The hotel has an extra fee for Wi-Fi.
- C) The hotel has an extra charge for Wi-Fi.
- D) The hotel has an extra cost for Wi-Fi.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 07**

**Which sentence correctly describes the cost of a bus trip to the airport?**

- A) The bus price to the airport is \$15.
- B) The bus fare to the airport is \$15.
- C) The bus fee to the airport is \$15.
- D) The bus cost to the airport is \$15.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 08**

**Which sentence correctly describes a recurring bank account cost?**

- A) The bank charges a monthly price of \$5 for the account.
- B) The bank charges a monthly payment of \$5 for the account.
- C) The bank charges a monthly fee of \$5 for the account.
- D) The bank charges a monthly bill of \$5 for the account.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 09**

**Which sentence best describes the total expense of a home renovation project?**

- A) The total price of the home renovation exceeded our budget.
- B) The total fee of the home renovation exceeded our budget.
- C) The total charge of the home renovation exceeded our budget.
- D) The total cost of the home renovation exceeded our budget.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_



**ITEM 10**

**Which sentence correctly reminds someone about a utility payment?**

- A) Don't forget to pay the electricity price by the end of the month.
- B) Don't forget to pay the electricity bill by the end of the month.
- C) Don't forget to pay the electricity charge by the end of the month.
- D) Don't forget to pay the electricity fee by the end of the month.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 11**

**Which sentence correctly describes regular car financing installments?**

- A) The car costs are \$300 per month for the next five years.
- B) The car fees are \$300 per month for the next five years.
- C) The car charges are \$300 per month for the next five years.
- D) The car payments are \$300 per month for the next five years.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 12**

**Which sentence best describes reducing monthly outgoings to save money?**

- A) We need to reduce our monthly costs to save more money.
- B) We need to reduce our monthly charges to save more money.
- C) We need to reduce our monthly expenses to save more money.
- D) We need to reduce our monthly fees to save more money.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 13**

**Which sentence correctly compares the price of organic produce to conventional options?**

- A) Organic produce is often more cost than conventional options.
- B) Organic produce is often more price than conventional options.
- C) Organic produce is often more expensive than conventional options.
- D) Organic produce is often more payment than conventional options.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 14**

**Which sentence best describes public transportation as an economical option?**

- A) Public transportation is usually a budget way to travel around the city.
- B) Public transportation is usually an inexpensive way to travel around the city.
- C) Public transportation is usually a bargain way to travel around the city.
- D) Public transportation is usually a discount way to travel around the city.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 15**

**Which sentence best describes increased hotel prices during peak season?**

- A) Hotel rates are expensive during the peak tourist season.
- B) Hotel rates are costly during the peak tourist season.
- C) Hotel rates are biggest during the peak tourist season.
- D) Hotel rates are high during the peak tourist season.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 16**

**Which sentence best describes reduced museum entry costs for students?**

- A) The entrance fee to the museum is quite cheaply for students.
- B) The entrance fee to the museum is quite invaluable for students.
- C) The entrance fee to the museum is quite low for students.
- D) The entrance fee to the museum is quite very much for students.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 17**

**Which sentence best describes increased utility costs in winter?**

- A) Our electricity bills are typical bigger in winter due to heating costs.
- B) Our electricity bills are typically larger in winter due to heating costs.
- C) Our electricity bills are typically higher in winter maybe heating costs.
- D) Our electricity bills are typically more big in winter due to heating costs.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 18**

**Which sentence correctly compares restaurant prices?**

- A) Among all the restaurants we visited, this one had the most expensive menu but the low service charges.
- B) Among all the restaurants we visited, this one had the expensivest menu but the lowest service charges.
- C) Among all the restaurants we visited, this one had the most expensive menu but the lowest service charges.
- D) Among all the restaurants we visited, this one had the more expensive menu but the more low service charges.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 19**

**Which question best asks if a price is fair?**

- A) Is this price logic?
- B) Is this price sensible?
- C) Is this price reasonable?
- D) Is this price intelligent?

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 20**

**Which question best asks if a student can manage the cost of an apartment?**

- A) Is this apartment affordable for a student?
- B) Is this apartment buyable for a student?
- C) Is this apartment purchasable for a student?
- D) Is this apartment obtainable for a student?

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 21**

**Which sentence correctly describes the current pricing for tutoring services?**

- A) They charge \$50 per hour for tutoring services.
- B) They charging \$50 per hour for tutoring services.
- C) They are charge \$50 per hour for tutoring services.
- D) They are charging \$50 per hour for tutoring services.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 22**

**Which question best asks about the price of an antique watch?**

- A) What is the cost of this antique watch?
- B) How is the cost of this antique watch?
- C) Where is the cost of this antique watch?
- D) When is the cost of this antique watch?

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 23**

**Which sentence best asks about the value of a painting?**

- A) How much is this painting worth?
- B) What does this painting cost?
- C) How expensive is this painting?
- D) What price is this painting?

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 24**

**Which sentence best describes a price reduction?**

- A) The store has lowered the cost of all summer clothing.
- B) The store has decreased the price of all summer clothing.
- C) The store has reduced the charge for all summer clothing.
- D) The store has minimized the fee for all summer clothing.

Correct choice: \_\_\_\_\_



## Self-check Answer Key

Use the key after you have completed every item on your own.

**Item 01** The correct answer is A. This question uses "How much" which is the most appropriate way to ask about price or cost.

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**Item 02** The correct answer is A. This sentence correctly uses "more than" to make a comparison.

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**Item 03** The correct answer is B. The phrase "too expensive" correctly expresses that the price exceeds an acceptable level.

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**Item 04** The correct answer is D. This sentence correctly uses "are charging" to describe an ongoing action.

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**Item 05** The correct answer is B. This sentence correctly uses "quite" to modify the adjective "reasonable".

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**Item 06** The correct answer is C. This sentence correctly uses "charge" to describe an additional payment for a service.

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**Item 07** The correct answer is B. This sentence correctly uses "fare" to describe the cost of transportation.

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**Item 08** The correct answer is C. This sentence correctly uses "fee" to describe a regular payment for a service.

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**Item 09** The correct answer is D. This sentence correctly uses "cost" to refer to the total sum of expenses.

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**Item 10** The correct answer is B. This sentence correctly uses "bill" to refer to an invoice for household utilities.

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**Item 11** The correct answer is D. This sentence correctly uses "payments" to describe regular installments on a large purchase.

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**Item 12** The correct answer is C. This sentence correctly uses "expenses" when discussing costs from a budgeting perspective.

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**Item 13** The correct answer is C. This sentence correctly uses "expensive" as an adjective to describe higher-priced items.

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**Item 14** The correct answer is B. This sentence uses "inexpensive" to describe a service that doesn't cost much. "Budget," "bargain," and "discount" are not as commonly used as adjectives in this context and sound less natural.

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**Item 15** The correct answer is D. This sentence correctly uses "high" to describe elevated prices.

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**Item 16** The correct answer is C. This sentence correctly uses "low" to describe a small fee.

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**Item 17** The correct answer is B. This sentence correctly uses "larger" to describe increased bills.

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**Item 18** The correct answer is C. This sentence correctly uses "most expensive" and "lowest" to make comparisons.

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**Item 19** The correct answer is C. This question correctly uses "reasonable" to inquire about the fairness of a price.

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**Item 20** The correct answer is A. This question correctly uses "affordable" to ask if the apartment is within a student's financial means.

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**Item 21** The correct answer is D. This sentence correctly uses "are charging" to describe an ongoing action.

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**Item 22** The correct answer is A. This question correctly uses "What" to inquire about the price or cost of an item.

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**Item 23** The correct answer is A. This question correctly uses "worth" to inquire about the value of an item.

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**Item 24** The correct answer is B. This sentence correctly uses "decreased the price" to describe a reduction in cost.

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